

CalClaim – Your Application Guide

Programs you may qualify for · how to apply · estimates only
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You may qualify for a total of ~\$29,998 this year (estimates only).

Step 1 – Find your documents

Pull these together first – each one unlocks estimated aid on your open applications (estimates only). Where a program accepts an award letter or pay stubs, that counts as one choice.

Document	Could save you (est.)
Filed tax return (use W-2s / 1099s to prepare it)	up to ~\$14,002/yr
Photo ID	up to ~\$12,996/yr
Pay stubs or benefit award letter	up to ~\$11,928/yr
W-2s and 1099s	up to ~\$10,246/yr
Utility account # or recent bill	up to ~\$3,840/yr

Per-document \$ can overlap when one program needs several docs. Your total at the top counts each open program once.

Step 2 – Apply now

These have an application you can start today. Tap each green URL to open the official apply page.

1. CARE · To do · energy

When: You can apply now.

Apply for CARE

Est. ~10 min to fill out the application

Apply via PG&E:

<https://www.pge.com/en/account/billing-and-assistance/financial-assistance/california-alternate-rates-for-energy-program.html>

Deadline: No deadline – apply anytime (confirm on the official site)

Documents needed: Utility account # or recent bill; Photo ID

How to apply (PG&E):

- Apply online for CARE on your PG&E account (shared CARE/FERA form)
- Have your PG&E account number or recent bill ready

2. LifeLine · To do · telecom

When: You can apply now.

Apply for LifeLine

Est. ~10 min to fill out the application

Apply:

<https://www.californialifeline.com/>

Deadline: No deadline – apply anytime (confirm on the official site)

Documents needed: Photo ID

How to apply:

- Confirm you qualify via income or categorical program
- Apply online or through your provider
- Keep approval letter

3. CalFresh · In progress · food

When: You can apply now.

Apply for CalFresh

Est. ~25 min to fill out the application

Apply via BenefitsCal:

<https://benefitscal.com/ApplyForBenefits/begin/ABOVR?lang=en>

Deadline: No deadline – apply anytime (confirm on the official site)

Documents needed: Photo ID; Pay stubs or benefit award letter

How to apply:

- Apply on BenefitsCal
- Report household and income
- Complete interview if required
- Submit documents if requested

4. ESA · To do · energy

When: You can apply now.

Apply for ESA

Est. ~10 min to fill out the application

Owner sign-off if renting.

Apply via PG&E:

<https://www.pge.com/en/save-energy-and-money/energy-saving-programs/energy-savings-assistance-program.html>

Deadline: No deadline – apply anytime (confirm on the official site)

Documents needed: Utility account # or recent bill

How to apply (PG&E):

- Apply or get referred through the PG&E ESA page
- Schedule an assessment if approved

For your tax preparer

Hand this box to VITA, a paid preparer, or tax software. These are credits to claim on the return – not applications to submit today.

1. Child Tax Credit (CTC)

Rough benefit: up to ~\$2,200/yr (estimate)

Claim on the return – do not apply now.

File by: Tax year 2026 federal filing deadline (2027-04-15)

Official page (type this URL):

<https://www.irs.gov/credits-deductions/individuals/child-tax-credit>

2. Federal Earned Income Tax Credit (EITC)

Rough benefit: up to ~\$8,046/yr (estimate)

Claim on the return – do not apply now.

File by: Tax year 2026 federal filing deadline (2027-04-15)

Official page (type this URL):

<https://www.irs.gov/credits-deductions/individuals/earned-income-tax-credit-eitc>

3. CalEITC

Rough benefit: up to ~\$3,756/yr (estimate)

Claim on the return – do not apply now.

File by: Tax year 2026 California filing deadline (2027-04-15)

Official page (type this URL):

<https://www.ftb.ca.gov/file/personal/credits/california-earned-income-tax-credit.html>

Closest deadline

CalEITC: Tax year 2026 California filing deadline (2027-04-15)

Already on

- (none marked yet)

Estimates only. Not affiliated with any agency or utility. Official agencies decide eligibility.
In Telegram: say "guide" to resend this file · STOP pauses reminders · erase deletes your data.
For more help, visit BenefitsCal at <https://benefitscal.com/>